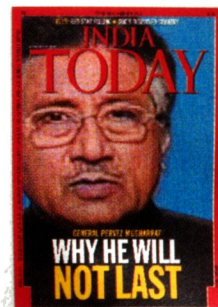


AP



"Why He will Not Last",
November 19, 2007

"Musharraf already holds more power than he deserves. He is the President and the supreme commander of the armed forces. What more does he want?"

J.S. ACHARYA, *Hyderabad*

General Unreliable

President Musharraf must make a graceful exit so that history remembers him as a kind man ("The Beginning of the End", November 19). After all, he is the catalyst of the modernisation and openness that can be seen in Pakistani society today.
MADHURI VALI, *on e-mail*

By imposing the Emergency, Musharraf has exposed his "democratic" credentials. With the US continuing to support him, there is little hope that external pressure would help the beleaguered Opposition get rid of the military ruler.
D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

It is high time that democracies like India and the US took a firm stand against military regime in Pakistan. We should not deal with our neighbour until democracy is restored there.
ABHILASH THADHANI, *on e-mail*

Musharraf should understand that it is better to lead a peaceful but long life than be after power and live a short and troubled life, a la Saddam Hussein.
MADHU AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

It is time that the Pakistani people woke up to protect the dignity of their democratic institutions and showed Musharraf and the extremists the door.
ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

The dictum "those who live by the sword, shall die by the sword" notwithstanding, a lucky Musharraf may yet again escape with a token punishment in the run-up to his ouster.
S.C. KAPOOR, *Noida*

Terrorism and nuclear weapons mixed with bad politics and martial law is a recipe for disaster. India would be the first one to be affected by the developments in Pakistan.
S.S. HALLIKERI, *on e-mail*

Torn between self-serving politicians and generals, the people of Pakistan need, but sadly lack, a credible, capable and selfless leader who can usher in a truly democratic modern nation.
Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

What is ironical about the uniformed President of Pakistan imposing the Emergency is the fact that this time he has carried out a second coup, unto none other than his own regime. Having dismantled every symbol of democracy, he has audaciously arrogated to himself the role of a Messiah, committed to ushering in "true democracy" in the strife-torn nation.
NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, *Thiruvananthapuram*

Tall Claim

It was amusing to read West Bengal's commerce secretary claiming that investors are still pursuing

the state ("Why Buddha is Not Smiling", November 19). He should know that according to noted economists Bibek Debroy and Laveesh Bhandari, the state ranks 15th amongst 20 big states in the country ("State of the States", September 24).

ASOKE C. BANERJEE, *Kolkata*

Battle Ready

When the going gets tough, the tough get going ("The Battle Heats Up", November 19). While dissidence in BJP's ranks may have dimmed Narendra Modi's chances, he may be able to prove the doomsayers wrong once again. This is what he has been doing for long.
T.S. PATTABHI RAMAN, *Coimbatore*

Masked Intelligence

The makeover plan of Maharashtra's SID is a typical bureaucratic exercise of killing two birds